



Scan: how to add it

Certificate in Financial Planning: any major, and transfers

Advising one-pager · students outside Gatton's business majors, and transfer students · 2026-27 catalog

Which sheet? Wealth management or financial planning: CFP. Investment research or portfolio management: CFA. Investment banking or private equity: Investment Banking. Real estate lending, investment, or development: Real Estate. Students can combine them. All sheets: willgerken.com/pathways

What it is

Financial planners help people manage money across investments, taxes, retirement, insurance, and estates. Personal financial advisors earned a **median of \$105,070** in 2025, according to the Bureau of Labor Statistics. The six courses satisfy the **education requirement** for CFP® certification; the exam, experience, and ethics requirements complete it. Open to any major, and full-time on-campus undergraduates add it in myGPS at **no additional tuition**. Every course requires **60 completed credit hours**: most students start as juniors, and students with AP or dual credit can often start as sophomores.

The six courses

Area	Course	Offered	Note
Fundamentals	FIN 350	Fall, spring	
Tax	ACC 357	Fall only	ACC 407 also counts but requires ACC 200 (or 202) and ACC 201
Investment	FIN 357	Spring only	FIN 410 also counts but requires finance and accounting prerequisites
Estate	ACC 457	Fall, spring	Its tax prerequisite is waived for certificate students
Retirement	FIN 358	Fall only	No alternate course
Capstone	FIN 359	Fall, spring	Taken last

In most majors outside Gatton all six are **free electives**, and every one is 300- or 400-level, so they also count toward upper-division hours.

Plan it once the student reaches 60 hours

Start	Semester 1	Semester 2	Semester 3	Semester 4
Fall start	FIN 350 , ACC 357	FIN 357 , ACC 457	FIN 358	FIN 359
Spring start	FIN 350 , FIN 357	ACC 357 , FIN 358	ACC 457	FIN 359
Faster, fall start	FIN 350 , ACC 357 , FIN 358	FIN 357 , ACC 457	FIN 359	
Pathway course	Counts for pathway and major ✓	Major requirement	UK Core, electives	<i>Italic = recommended</i>
				One term only

Transfer students

- **Arriving with 60 or more hours?** A transfer student can start the certificate in the first semester at UK.
- **Completed CFP coursework at another CFP Board Registered Program?** Talk with the program director before registering.

Three things to know

1. **Any major, no extra tuition.** Six upper-division electives, 18 credit hours, open to students in every college.
2. **Take FIN 358 in a fall, and never leave it for last.** It has no second term and no substitute, so a student who starts in senior spring, or reaches that term without it, cannot finish before graduating (Executive Education afterward costs \$895 a course).
3. **Follow the row for the starting term.** ACC 357 runs only in fall and FIN 357 only in spring, so the order matters more than the pace.

After the certificate

- Students can sit for the CFP exam as soon as their completion is reported. The experience requirement (6,000 hours, or 4,000 through an apprenticeship) and the bachelor's degree can both be finished after the exam.
- Licenses depend on the job: Series 65 or 66 for RIA roles; SIE, Series 7, and 63 or 66 for broker-dealers; state life and health for insurance. We **recommend the SIE** for every student: it needs no sponsoring firm and is not required for the CFP.
- Get involved: the Finance Society's Financial Planning Pathway.

To add the certificate: talk with an advisor, then myUK → myGPS → My Program of Study → Request a Major Change → Add a Major, and search for Financial Planning. Details: gatton.uky.edu/certificate-financial-planning, or scan the code at top.

Terms. Free elective: any course the student chooses that counts toward graduation hours. Upper-division: courses numbered 300 and above. SIE: Securities Industry Essentials, FINRA's entry-level exam.

Director: Will Gerken, CFP®, will.gerken@uky.edu · Sequences follow the program's recommended pacing; the catalog year a student entered under governs.